



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

MINUTES of the MEETING
Monday, November 7, 2022, at 7:00 PM

The Westhampton Selectboard scheduled a regular meeting to be held on Monday, November 7, 2022, at 7:00 PM at the Town Offices, 1 South Road, and via video-conference.¹

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7 PM by Phil Dowling, Chair.

PRESENT: Phil Dowling, Maureen Dempsey, Scott Johndrow

ALSO PRESENT: Mr. Bill Jablonski (Highway Superintendent); Mr. Douglas Finn;

APPOINTMENT – Winter Sidewalk Maintenance

A letter of interest from Mr. Richard Tracy was reviewed. After brief deliberation and consultation with Mr. Jablonski, it was MOVED by Dowling, SECONDED by Johndrow,

To appoint Mr. Richard Tracy as Winter Sidewalk Custodian.

VOTED: 2, 0, 1 (DEMPSEY ABSTAINS) (7:02 PM)

UPDATE (anticipated) – "Vicious / Dangerous Dog" Complaint – schedule public hearing

Mr. Finn noted recent correspondence with Ms. Kelli Wainscott, ACO for the Town of Chesterfield, and Chief David White, in which it was noted that (a) the owner of the dog in question had been contacted, and had agreed to a tentative remedy going forward. Ms. Wainscott noted that the General Law required a public hearing to be conducted. Mr. Finn advised that such a hearing be scheduled for the next regular meeting.

Agreed by acclamation; Mr. Finn will notify all parties by certified mail.

Mr. Dowling noted that a 'vicious dog' ruling could be damaging for homeowners; he expressed relief that the situation should be able to be resolved quickly.

DEPARTMENT AND COMMITTEE UPDATES

a. Highway (Bill Jablonski)

Mr. Jablonski reported on recent work:

Inspection on the Fire Chief's vehicle is complete; catch basin cleaning is ongoing; safety complex grading is complete; first layer of pavement at the Public Safety Complex is complete; bollards at the safety complex are installed; three days of crack sealing on route

¹ Pursuant to Chapter 20 of the Acts of 2021, the meeting was conducted as a "hybrid" (in-person / remote) meeting. Members of the public could access the meeting in person, or connect via "zoom" teleconferencing via internet – Meeting ID#: 870 4390 0582.

66 is complete; finished paving at the public safety complex is done. Mr. Jablonski noted that both he and his staff put in significant amount of extra time over the week in order to get all work done.

Ms. Marilyn Witherell had some questions in regard to the process of crack-sealing on Route 66.

b. Health (Robby Armenti)

Ms. Armenti submitted a written report. Mr. Finn also noted that information about RSV (respiratory syncytial virus) was posted on the Town's website.

c. Public Safety Building (Phil Dowling)

Mr. Dowling noted that the second layer of paving was completed, sidewalks are completed, and acknowledge the significant contributions of the highway department in getting the site in place.

Significant finish work on plumbing, electrical, and IT work is ongoing.

The floors will be sealed on the following Saturday; there was discussion relative to painting guidelines on the internal bays.

Mr. Dowling noted that budget numbers are firming up, and requested action to appropriate ARPA funds at the next Selectboard meeting. A comprehensive budget will be available at the next meeting.

Mr. Dowling noted that the floors will be sealed within about ten days. A partial Certificate of Occupancy may be sought to allow the equipment to be stored in the bay, while the 'crew quarters' were being completed.

d. MVP (Teri Anderson)

Mr. Finn offered a reminder about the public information and 'visioning' session on November 9.

OTHER NEW BUSINESS (may include items not reasonably anticipated at time of posting)

Tentative: Financial Salary Discussion

Mr. Dowling noted that the salary discussion and any adjustments would be an ongoing conversation with the finance committee, and suggested taking the matter up after the first of the year.

ADMINISTRATIVE

Review Correspondence

There was some discussion in regard to composting as a municipal activity. No action taken.

Review of Payroll and A/P Warrants: W23-9, WP23-9

After review, it was MOVED by Dempsey, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve payroll warrant WP23-10.

VOTED:, 3, 0, 0. (7:23 PM)

After review, it was MOVED by Dowling, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve A/P Warrant W23-10.

VOTED: 2, 0, 1 (DEMPSEY ABSTAINS) (7:23 PM)

Review / Approve Minutes

The minutes of October 24 and November 1, 2022 were reviewed. After review, it was MOVED by Dempsey, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the minutes of November 1, 2022, as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:24 PM)

It was MOVED by Dempsey, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the Minutes of October 24, 2022, as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:24 PM)

Next Meeting Date

Mr Dowling noted that the date for the next meeting would be Monday, November 21, 2022, at 7 PM.

Adjourn

It was MOVED by Dowling, SECONDED by Johndrow

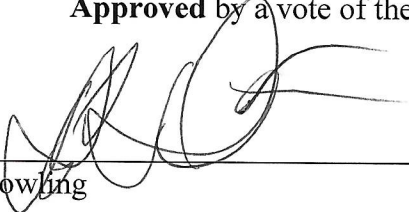
To Adjourn.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:25 PM)

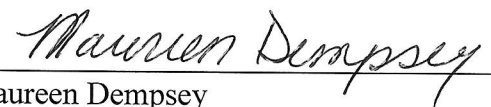
Respectfully submitted,

Douglas C. Finn

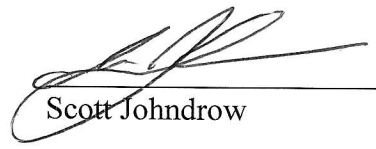
Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on _____, 2022.



Phil Dowling



Maureen Dempsey



Scott Johndrow